Model 10 Electra

P-38 Lightning

L-1049 Super Constellation

F-22 Raptor

1912 Allan and Malcolm Loughead form the Alco Hydro-Aeroplane Company.
1919 Allan Loughead forms Lockheed Aircraft Manufacturing Company.
1920 The S-1 Sports biplane is developed by Loughead and attracts interest.
1927 The advanced Lockheed Vega makes its maiden flight.
1929 The Lockheed Aircraft Company is sold to Detroit Aircraft, then it goes bust.
1931 The revived Lockheed Aircraft Corporation launches the Orion.
1934 The Lockheed Model 10 Electra takes to the air for the first time.
1936 The Electra Junior, or Lockheed 12, takes to the air.
1941 The first of more than 9,000 P-38 Lightning fighters goes into service.
1943 Lockheed's secret Skunk Works is set up in Burbank, California.
1945 The P-80 Shooting Star becomes the first US operational jet fighter.
1951 The L-1049 Super Constellation is brought into service.
1954 Lockheed's C-130 Hercules transport and the F-104 Starfighter take flight.
1957 The Lockheed U-2 spyplane enters USAF service and the Electra turboprop airliner is launched.
1962 Developed from the Electra airliner, the P-3A Orion joins the US Navy.
1964 Mach 3 SR-71 Blackbird's maiden flight takes place. It goes into service with the USAF two years later.
1970 Lockheed's L-1011 TriStar three-engined, wide-body jet airliner is introduced.
1977 The company is renamed the Lockheed Corporation to reflect its other interests.
1981 The F-117 Nighthawk "Stealth Fighter" makes its first flight.
1986 The improved C-5B Galaxy super transport joins the USAF.
1991 Production of the F-22 Raptor begins with Boeing and General Dynamics.
1995 Lockheed merges with Martin Marietta to create Lockheed Martin.
1996 New generation C-130J Hercules flies.

Shooting Star. This first flew in January 1944 and later took part in the Korean War. It was the first aircraft to emerge from Lockheed's new top secret Advanced Development Division, better known as "The Skunk Works." This source produced a host of secret development programs.From its experience in the Korean War, the USAF realized it needed a more capable transport aircraft than those it had in service. Lockheed's solution was the C-130 Hercules. This entered US military service in 1957 and, upgraded many times, remains in service today—a record matched by few other types. In 1955, Lockheed Skunk Works unveiled a visionary new design—the U-2. Conceived as an ultra-high-altitude reconnaissance aircraft, the U-2 was used over the Soviet Union during the Cold War era and remains a spy in the sky today.

Following on from the U-2, Lockheed's SR-71 Blackbird stunned the aviation world. An advanced strategic reconnaissance aircraft with a top speed of more than 2,284 mph (3,675 km/h), the SR-71 was operated by the USAF for more than three decades. Lockheed's next two projects were military and civil transports. The massive C-5A Galaxy gave the USAF an invaluable airlift capability and still remains in service today. The L-1011 Tristar wide-bodied airliner was introduced in 1970 and entered commercial service two years later. However, Lockheed's involvement with commercial aviation ceased in 1986 with the delivery of the last Tristars. The Skunk Works had one more military surprise: the F-117A Nighthawk, better known as the "Stealth Fighter." Revolutionary when unveiled in the late 1980s, the F-117A's airframe incorporated a large amount of "stealth" technology. The Nighthawk was retired in 2008 after a career with the USAF that included operations over Panama, the Gulf (in 1991 and 1998), and the Balkans. In 1995, the Lockheed story ended when the firm merged with Martin Marietta to create Lockheed Martin.

SR-71 Blackbird
The Lockheed SR-71 was the USAF's most powerful reconnaissance craft, flying so high and fast it could not be intercepted. Known as the Blackbird, it remained in USAF and NASA service from 1966 until finally retired in 1999.

The future of Lockheed
This supersonic aircraft was designed by Lockheed and funded by NASA. A passenger plane of this kind may be produced in the future by Lockheed by around 2025.